

Swapping, Tuple, Dictionary & Complex

Meaning of “Swapping” in Programming

Swapping means **exchanging the values** of two variables. In other words – making variable A take the value of B, and variable B take the value of A.

Example (Before and After Swapping)

```
a = 5
b = 10

# Before swapping:
# a = 5
# b = 10

# Swap using Python tuple unpacking
a, b = b, a

# After swapping:
# a = 10
# b = 5
```

What Happened Here?

The right side (b, a) creates a tuple of current values → (10, 5). Python then assigns those values to (a, b) on the left side. So a gets 10 and b gets 5.

Why Is It Useful?

- Sorting numbers or items (like in sorting algorithms).
- Temporarily switching values between two variables.

Another Example (Step-by-step with Temporary Variable)

```
a = 5
b = 10

# Swap using a temporary variable
temp = a
a = b
b = temp

print(a, b) # Output: 10 5
```

 **In short:** Swapping means exchanging two values so that each variable takes the other's value.

What is a Tuple?

A **tuple** is like a list, but it **cannot be changed** (we say it's *immutable*). That means – once you create it, you cannot add, remove, or change its items.

Example

```
# A tuple of student names
students = ("Alice", "Bob", "John")
print(students)

# Output:
# ('Alice', 'Bob', 'John')
```

How to access tuple items

```
print(students[0]) # prints 'Alice'
print(students[-1]) # prints 'John'
```

Uses of Tuple

- When you want to store **fixed data** that should not change.
- Tuples use less memory than lists, so they are more efficient.
- Good for read-only data.

Real-Life Examples

```
# Days of the week
days = ("Monday", "Tuesday", "Wednesday", "Thursday", "Friday", "Saturday", "Sunday")

# Coordinates on a map (x, y)
point = (10, 20)

# Storing constant information like (country code, country name)
country = ("RW", "Rwanda")
```

2 Dictionary

What is a Dictionary?

A **dictionary** stores data in **key-value pairs**. Think of it like a real-life dictionary – you look up a *word* (key) to find its *meaning* (value).

Example

```
student = {
    "name": "Alice",
    "age": 20,
    "course": "Computer Science"
```

```
}  
  
# Here:  
# "name" is the key, and "Alice" is the value.
```

Accessing values

```
print(student["name"]) # prints Alice  
  
# Adding new data  
student["grade"] = "A"  
  
# Changing a value  
student["age"] = 21
```

Uses of Dictionary

- When you need to store related data together.
- When you want to find information quickly using a **key**.
- Very useful in real-world applications like managing databases or APIs.

Real-Life Examples

```
# Student record  
student = {"id": 1, "name": "Alice", "marks": 85}  
  
# Contact list  
contact = {"name": "John", "phone": "0789-123-456"}  
  
# Product details  
product = {"name": "Laptop", "price": 950.0, "in_stock": True}
```

3 Complex (Complex Numbers)

What is a Complex Number?

A **complex number** has two parts: a **real part** and an **imaginary part**. In Python, you write it like this:

```
z = 3 + 4j
```

Here: 3 → Real part, 4j → Imaginary part (notice the letter j, not i as in math)

Accessing parts

```
print(z.real) # Output: 3.0  
print(z.imag) # Output: 4.0
```

Math with complex numbers

```
a = 2 + 3j
b = 1 + 4j
print(a + b) # Output: (3+7j)
```

 Uses of Complex Numbers

- In engineering, physics, and mathematics for calculations involving waves, electricity, or signals.
- Used in scientific computing, such as electrical circuit analysis or control systems.

 Real-Life Examples

- Electrical engineering: AC calculations use complex numbers to represent voltage and current.
- Robotics: complex numbers can represent rotation and movement.
- Data science: used in Fourier Transforms (audio and image processing).

 Summary Table

Data Type	Looks Like	Can Change?	Main Use	Real-Life Example
Tuple	("red", "blue", "green")	 No	Store fixed data	Days of the week
Dictionary	{"name": "Alice", "age": 20}	 Yes	Store key-value pairs	Student record
Complex	3 + 4j	 Yes	Math/Science calculations	Electrical signals